



September 2025

CONTINUAL
PROFESSIONAL
DEVELOPMENT

Welcome to the Finance Planning monthly round-up newsletter for September 2025,

As we enter the final quarter of the year, it is the perfect time to focus on finishing 2025 strongly. With just a few months to go, now is a great chance to make a final push with our clients to round off the year on a high note.

It's also a great moment to check in on your CPD progress. Staying on top of your learning not only keeps you compliant but ensures you are best equipped to provide exceptional advice as the market continues to evolve.

Looking ahead, all eyes will be on the Autumn Budget on 26th November, and interesting news in the last few days around a UK government consultation aiming to simplify the homebuying process in England—something we'll be keeping a close watch on over the coming months.

In this month's newsletter, you'll find a detailed compliance update from Pete, some insightful protection news from Matt, and a look at some truly impressive results in the Performance update and Millionaire Club. As always, thank you for your continued hard work, professionalism, and dedication—it really does make a difference.

Let's make this final stretch of the year our strongest yet!

Hope everyone has a great October.

Thank you.

David

Compliance News 17/25 (Product Transfers – Record Keeping process)

In an effort to level up the Product Transfer process with lenders, and to ease the burden on clients providing PT paperwork when they know they don't need to [by going direct to their lender] we have agreed to the waiving of the usual documentation where your client can meet the following criteria:

1. Did you arrange their previous mortgage? **(yes)**
2. Is the borrowing with the same lender (PT rather than re-mortgage)? **(yes)**
3. Has the repayment type of the mortgage remained unchanged? **(yes)**
4. Is the amount being borrowed increasing? **(no)**
5. Is the term (years) of the mortgage unchanged? **(yes)**
6. Is there any 'transfer of equity' or other change in ownership of the mortgage? **(no).**

Two important matters though. Firstly, you must copy and paste these six points in to your Acre Notes page, and secondly, this is the minimum standards. You still might prefer to ask for a bank statement and payslip and then waive them if/when the client objects. You will still need to complete a full fact find with your clients and this will include the completion of an up-to-date budget planner. You might therefore need to update your sales process slightly where you currently rely on a bank statement to assist with the budget planner being completed.

BTLs and Tax Evasion

OK, so whilst we are waiving the need for evidence of land and property tax being declared on BTL PTs that meet the criteria above, you are reminded of the importance of ensuring we do still obtain these for any re-mortgage transactions where we are introducing the client to a new lender. This is because the Criminal Finances Act 2017 introduced criminal offences relating to the evasion of UK and foreign taxes. Whilst the Act didn't change what is classed as an offence, it did extend accountability to Firms, and its Advisers, who provide services which are seen to criminally facilitate tax evasion. Essentially this could make us liable if an Adviser submits a mortgage application for an individual where it is known that tax is being evaded; either through earned income or property income.

We would therefore suggest that for PT business where you are collecting no documents, that at the very least you are reminding clients of the need to declare their rental income to the taxman.

Windows 10 operating system

Microsoft's support for Windows 10 will end on 14th October 2025. Beyond this date there will be no further security updates, and your computer will be at an increased vulnerability to security risks and viruses.

Action. You must ensure your computer is running Windows 11. If you are still on Windows 10 you will need to upgrade to Windows 11 immediately. If your computer will not upgrade

to Windows 11 then you must purchase a new computer with Windows 11 Pro installed. (apple users are excused!). If you are in any doubt, please speak with your Sales Manager.

Protection Record Keeping

We are currently 'focus checking' some of your protection advice cases. The purpose of this is to ensure the record keeping standards are being met. Regrettably, we are finding many instances where our standards are not being met, or where the quality of the Suitability Letter is poor. Here are some common issues:

- Protection sourcing list not on file
- Protection 'agreed budget amount' not included in the protection fact find budget planner (as even though the section will be ticked green, you still need a figure in that box or else your SL will read that they had a budget of £0.00)
- No explanation of why you have recommended the insurer
- No explanation of why the cheapest insurer has not been recommended, or where the cheapest CIC insurer has been recommended, why Guardian has not been recommended first, or at least discounted
- Recommending a low cost (2 year or 5 year) IP product instead of starting with full cover to the client's retirement
- Lack of the use of Notes to provide soft facts, or to explain where the cover is declined or postponed
- Where there is no protection sale, a lack of the Letter One (no protection letter) or Notes/Emails which evidence the client not wanting protection
- Lack of the use of Notes, and a lack of addendum letters, where a client is rated
- Poor quality Suitability Letters with Advisers simply typing a couple of words where we would expect a paragraph copied over from the document which lists all available paragraphs
 - Please remember that this is a report of what you have done and why you have done it, so where it says "I have recommended this product because:" please ensure you say something about why the product meets their needs and objectives (think level of cover, length or term, deferred periods, reason for the insurer, etc.)
- Generally, the cases need to tell more of a story than they do currently, in many instances.

We really want to help Advisers to raise the standards, and so where you are unsure, or where you wish for us to check a case, then please do ask for help. Similarly, where we check a case and provide remedial work, then again, please ask us to help you with addressing the issues where you are unsure.

This is all really important because where your letter doesn't fully explain your advice, or where our advice standards have not been followed, then if there is an issue in the future you might not be covered by our PI insurance.

Self Employed Accounts

A reminder that most lenders will no longer accept income evidence where the most recent tax year is April 2023/2024.

Client Complaints

We've recently had two complaints which we'd like to share with you to help prevent similar occurrences in the future.

In the first complaint [Miss N](#) alleges that our Adviser withheld medical information from the insurer when submitting her income protection application to L&G.

Case decision and our reasoning: **Not Upheld** (There were sufficient medical disclosures made to the insurer for us to understand that our Adviser has not simply dismissed the need to provide full answers to all medical questions. There is also a Note in the Point of Sale system which confirms "the application was submitted during a teams meeting with the client where we answered all questions". This type of soft fact is really invaluable in helping defend a complaint, as is any saved 'data capture forms' or emails between you and the client asking them to double check all answers. These types of complaint are inevitable when an insurer declines a claim for non-disclosure, as clients desperately seek to blame others for their own omissions. So please do consider how you can be protecting yourselves now, against possible complaints in the future.)

In the second complaint [Miss R](#) was unhappy that our Adviser was unable to secure her a mortgage, leaving her financially disadvantaged.

Case decision and our reasoning: **Not Upheld** (It was an unfortunate situation of the client non-disclosing to us the extent of her poor credit. An 'arrangement to pay' wasn't on the version of the credit report that the client provided our Adviser. Furthermore, the extent of her debts and missed payments (and desire to debt consolidate) meant that although a DIP passed with two different lenders, the manual underwriters felt the case was outside of the lenders' risk appetite. The learn here is to always ask for an up-to-date credit report, and where some time elapses between two applications always be asking if their situation has changed and obtain a further credit report. Again, the client might well be blaming us for being unable to secure them the borrowing they needed, but ultimately it is their life choices to be spending well beyond their means which is the root cause of the problem.)

Some other interesting complaints against others firms

Here is a short selection of some complaints which have recently been published by FOS:

[Miss B](#) had approached a mortgage advice firm to discuss mortgage options. However, whilst taking her time considering her options, the advice firm had secured and accepted a mortgage offer on her behalf.

Case decision and AMI commentary: **Upheld** (Firms need to make sure they receive explicit consent to progress with any case to avoid any potential confusion and extra fees.)

[Mrs B](#) approached her current lender for support available under the Mortgage Charter. Unfortunately, the lender was not adequately trained and provided conflicting information.

Case decision and AMI commentary: **Upheld** (Advisers and firms need to be wary of providing information, and advice, regarding the support available from the Mortgage Charter. If there is any confusion or misunderstanding, this should be resolved before providing information to customers that could cause foreseeable harm.)

[Mr and Mrs C](#) believed they were mis-sold a mortgage and were provided incorrect advice regarding an ERC on their existing mortgage.

Case decision and AMI commentary: **Not Upheld** (Advisers are dependent on their customers providing correct and up-to-date information regarding any existing Early Repayment Charges (ERCs). It is prudent that advisers encourage their customers to double check this information with their current lender to help budget for any potential large ERCs.)



When it comes to families, few things matter more to parents than protecting their children. That's why MetLife's *Child Shield* policy has been a game changer for both clients and advisers. Take Paul Gent, for example. He recommends *Child Shield* to every client with children. Out of 18 conversations, 17 have resulted in a sale — a conversion rate any adviser would envy.

One of those clients was Paul's own PA, Leah. She opted for two units of cover at just £11 per month. Not long after, her daughter broke her arm in two places. MetLife classified it as a "bad break" and paid out £1,200 — proof of the policy's real-world value.

From Leah's perspective, it was a relief to have quick, straightforward financial support at a stressful time. From an adviser's perspective, it's worth noting that this £11 monthly policy also generates £211.80 in commission.

For advisers, *Child Shield* is more than just a product. It's a way to provide families with meaningful protection, while unlocking a valuable revenue stream. If you're not recommending it to clients with children, you might be leaving both peace of mind — and income — on the table.

We have a new MetLife BDM to help you with any queries on the above or their other products

Ben Schaefer - 01273 876 180 ben.schaefer@metlife.com

TOP Protection Updates:

Income Protection Awareness Week (IPAW) took place in September again this year, giving brokers the chance to hear from expert speakers, gain practical insights, and pick up free CPD along the way. If you missed any of the sessions, don't worry — you can still catch up online and make the most of the valuable content available on the IPAW website... <https://iptf.co.uk/ipaw-2025/>

Holloway – A reminder that Holloway have lots of bite-sized videos that you can watch to not only brush up on your product knowledge but also your sales skills. Videos start at just 2 mins long so can easily be watched whilst you're on hold to any banks or insurance providers!

L&G – Matt is in regular communications with one of the Technical Heads of the OLP system L&G use. Any feedback good or bad would be appreciated so we can help them rough out the edges of their systems and make it more user friendly...



In this mortgage update we are minimising the number of product or specific criteria changes as you can review these from the vast array of emails you receive from lenders each day.

Santander

Santander have announced that their PT products will now be available to source directly via Acre rather than having to create them manually which is great news and a good time saver. At the same time they also confirmed that you can now view your clients mortgage details via their website at any time rather than just within the PT window.

Generation Home

We have a new BDM with Generation Home. Joshua Holmes is now looking after us, he can be reached on

- T: 07897 036783
- E: joshua.holmes@generationhome.com

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)

performance

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for September 2025

Congratulations to **Paul Gent** for topping our mortgage table in September.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	42
Jack Savory	35
Rob Chart	33
Jonathan Peachey	32
Emily Chattaway	28
Dan Fletcher	27
Phil Smith	21
Pratima Gurung	21
Cathy Rafferty	20
Paul Goodey	19
Carl Thorne	18
Joanne Pope	18
Dipes Rai	15
Joe White	15
Binita Gurung	14
Alex Strange	13
Dan Walsh	13
Jack Humphries	13
Joe Maskell	13
Ellis Featherbe	13
Claire Lipscombe	12
Gary Bray	12
Carrie Millin	11
Dan Grant	11
Eddie Rozario	11
Karen Mills	11
Matt Stephens	11
Paul Ripley	11
Smriti Pun	11
Jim Maye	10
Peter Stickley	10
Richard Lucy	10
Stuart Hunnisett	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for September 2025

Congratulations to **Paul Gent** for topping the protection table in September.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	47
Clare Mann	31
Rob Chart	30

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables

Should anyone feel their applications are not being calculated properly, please speak to your Sales Manager as it might mean those cases you have submitted to a lender or insurer have not been recorded as such on Acre yet and we can show you how to fix that.



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases this year. Lots of new entries this month so congratulations to all. Cases added in the last month are shown in **blue**.

Mortgage cases

Paul Goodey	£3,881,250
Romi Pal	£3,207,525
Chris Williams	£2,377,875
Paul Goodey	£2,306,000
Paul Goodey	£2131,737
Wilma Scott	£1,762,500
Paul Goodey	£1,742,815
Paul Goodey	£1,629,776
Oliver Cunningham	£1,510,450
Paul Goodey	£1,500,000
Paul Ripley	£1,462,000
Joanne Pope	£1,454,540
Victoria Worthington	£1,410,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,400,000
Romi Pal	£1,385,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,380,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,370,000
Carrie Millin	£1,335,897
Victoria Wescott	£1,300,074
Paul Goodey	£1,300,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,291,980
Wilma Scott	£1,268,688
Trevor Farley	£1,237,393
Rob Chart	£1,234,503

Ellis Featherbe	£1,207,000
Paul Goodey	£1,207,000
Jonathon Peachey	£1,200,000
Marion Hunnisett	£1,125,000
Emily Chattaway	£1,170,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,150,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,105,000
Joanne Pope	£1,083,660
Paul Goodey	£1,072,000
Claire Lipscomb	£1,067,698
Peter Stickley	£1,051,495
Cathy Rafferty	£1,020,000
Paul Goodey	£1,015,521
Jim Maye	£1,014,681
Karen Mills	£1,006,820
Joanne Pope	£1,005,699
Carrie Millin	£1,003,373
Paul Goodey	£1,001,054
Joanne Pope	£1,000,000

Protection cases

Dave Relfe	Exec IPB £3,838,800
Dave Relfe	Exec IPB £3,729,120
Paul Gent	Life £2,400,000
Paul Gent	RLP £2,400,000
Victoria Wescott	Life £2,352,000
Paul Gent	IPB £2,339,073
Simon Maskell	Life £1,881,000
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,863,948
Simon Maskell	IPB £1,840,000
Lorraine Smith	Life £1,560,790
Ellis Featherbe	Life £1,500,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,400,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,400,000
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,240,320
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,164,801
Paul Gent	IPB £1,128,204
Richard Lucy	Life £1,000,000
Dave Relfe	RLP £1,000,000
Dave Relfe	RLP £1,000,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,000,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,000,000

As with the mortgage and protection figures if you feel an application you have made should be referenced here, please speak to your sales manager to confirm if it is showing on Acre correctly.



FPG Anniversaries

So far in 2025 we have seen some very significant milestones reached in terms of service within the Finance Planning Group especially as this is the 25th year of The Finance Planning Group. A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Kate Joyice – 21 years
- Dan Grant – 12 years
- Paul Ripley – 10 years
- Nicki Hart – 10 years
- Phil Smith – 9 years
- Lynn Strange – 8 years
- Phoebe Wight – 7 years
- Jack Savory – 5 years
- Emma Langford – 5 years
- Richard Saunders – 5 years
- Roberta Thiruthippully – 3 years
- Trevor Speid – 2 years
- Chobi Gurung – 1 year
- Lokesh Gurung – 1 year

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list that should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in October.

- Caitlin Ferguson
- Dan Maskell
- Simon Maskell
- Dipes Rai
- Jack Humphries
- Julie Parks
- Leah Moffitt
- Terry Mills
- Tina Wisdom
- Tony Hornby

miscellaneous

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status. We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable, please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

September Zoom sessions

Here are the details of the Zoom sessions FPG hosted in September and the links to re-watch them.

01/09/2025 – Skipton and Pete - <https://knowledgehub.website/1-09-2025-skipton-and-pete/>

08/09/2025 – BM Solutions - <https://knowledgehub.website/08-09-2025-mark-penfold-bm-solutions/>

15/09/2025 – Virgin Money - <https://knowledgehub.website/15-09-2025-virgin-money/>

22/09/2025 – Income Protection Week Kick Off - <https://knowledgehub.website/22-09-2025-income-protection-week-kick-off/>